

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1988-12-13

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dear bahá'í friends,
2 to inform you that two believers who had been imprisoned in iran for some
3 time, have recently been executed.

mr. bihnám páshá'í, a resident of Simnán and member of the local

4 Spiritual Assembly of that city, had been arrested on 19 November 1983 in Tehran. in
the summer of 1988 he was transferred to evin prison and his

5 family has not been permitted to see him since july 1988. The news of his

execution was communicated to his family on 3 december 1988. he was

49 years old.

50 mr. páshá'í was from a muslim family and accepted the faith some years
51 ago, the only member of his family to do so. it is assumed that this was the
52 reason for his execution, for the authorities in iran are known to be very
53 severe on those who independently accept the faith, considering them to be
54 apostates according to islamic law.

55 The other bahá'í recently executed was mr. íraj Afshín. he was arrested
56 late in 1986 and his family has not been allowed to see him since 17 july 58.3

58 4

59 1

59 2

59 3

59 4

60 message from The Universal House of Justice

61 1021988. News of his execution was given to his family on 26 November 1988.

62 he was 55 years old.

63 mr. Afshín was a colonel in the iranian Air force, and the authorities

64 maintain that his execution was on political grounds due to his connections with
royalists, members of a group opposed to the government. it is
65 established, however, that mr. Afshín had not engaged in political activities,
66 that he firmly maintained his faith throughout his imprisonment, and that he was
assigned to a prison ward where other bahá'ís were kept.
67 To date, neither the exact charges, nor the dates of execution nor the
68 places of burial are known for these two latest victims.
69 it was also reported that 36 bahá'í prisoners had recently been in great
70 danger of execution. They were housed in a prison ward together with many
mujaheddin and communists. one night, when their fellow prisoners
71 were rounded up for execution, the 36 bahá'ís were also taken out with
72 them, blindfolded and lined up to be shot. Among them were two very old bahá'ís,
mr. vafá'í of isfahan and mr. ma'lúmí of Sangsar. casually,
73 one of the guards asked these two men what they had done at their age to
74 deserve being shot. They answered that they were bahá'ís, whereupon their
75 executioners said that they had no orders to shoot bahá'ís. fortunately, the
76 other bahá'ís overheard these remarks and all stepped forward identifying
77 themselves as such and, in this way, they were spared. . . .
78 with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat

79 60

Individual Rights and Freedoms

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]